Swords and Sacrifices

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Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
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Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Additional Tags:
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Swords and Sacrifices

by ResFlower

Summary

"I want her to know , I just worry ."Adora bites her lip as she turns, checking on some of the patients. She holds a small kitten and pets it as she continues.

"There is a dif ference between dating a vet tech and a superhero. I mean, what if it's too much? What if I'm too much?" Adora lowers her gaze as she gives voice to her deepest insecurities.

"Adora, you could never be too much for Catra. I've seen how that girl looks at you, she is head over heels in love."Adora's face reddens deeply at the mention of love. She busies herself by putting the kitten back. Starla picks up on it, her eyes widen.

"W ait- have you not told Catra you love her yet?" Adora looks away and puts her face in her head, groaning. It's enough of an answer for Starla.

"Adora!" Starla exclaims, slapping Adora's arm. Adora's cheeks somehow blaze hotter.

OR

Adora finally tells her girlfriend she is a superhero. Superhero AU.

Notes

As always, thank you to BlueCoin00 for beta reading my fics and bonking me over the head when I need to write better. Hope y'all enjoy it!

See the end of the work for more notes

Adora shoves her sword straight through a bot, skewering it, then swings with all her strength, causing the bot to fly off and knock a clone out. She grins at that. It is always hard to fight near Bright Moon's downtown because there isnt much visibility and there are always more civilians in the way.

She hates bots. She hates clones. She hates Prime. Fights with him are always exhausting and the cult-like monologues hit a little too close to home for Adora. It reminds her of growing up in the Grayskull Squadron where everything revolves around meeting the First One's mission.

The rest of the Alliance is having a blast, wrecking bots and clones alike.

"Entrapta! How much longer until you get these bots of fline?" Glimmer shouts as her magic burns through a group of clones reaching Arrow. He smiles gratefully at her and continues to shoot down bots. Entrapta types away on one of her tablets that she connects to a Prime server.

"I'm not sure, I need to get both the clones and the bots down all at the same time for them to stay disabled. It's fascinating that one system can reboot the other, I wonder how Prime does it." Entrapta continues to mutter to herself as she types furiously.

Adora can see that the Alliance is slowly getting overwhelmed, it has been a good thirty minutes of non-stop fighting and new clones and bots keep deploying at the same pace. Seems Prime's strategy is to slowly tire them out.

Until something different happens. The ground shakes and one of the buildings near them breaks clean in half revealing a bot Adora has never seen before.

The huge bot, perhaps ten times the size of a standard bot rumbles as it makes its way into the fray. Adora's grip tightens on her sword

as she prepares to cut through the bot in front of her and try a run at the giant thing when she hears it.

"I got it!" Wildcat yells, then she starts running full speed at Scorpia yelling, "Boost me Scorp!"

Wildcat hops up onto Scorpia's shoulders, using them as a jumping point. As Wildcat pounces, Scorpia shifts her weight, giving more momentum to Wildcat's jump. The move looks practiced, and the effect is amazing.

Wildcat looks like she is slingshot off Scorpia's shoulders and she tears her tech claws into the bot. She uses the leverage to climb to the top, whooping as she sits in its blind spot.

Other bots that are targeting Wildcat continue to shoot at her. Instead of hitting her, they slowly destroy the massive bot Wildcat sits on, effectively disabling their best weapon without getting a shot at Wildcat. It takes another half hour, but between the Alliance attacking the larger bot and Prime's own bots accidentally helping them, the bot screeches to a halt.

"Work smarter, not harder." Wildcat preens from atop the now wrecked bot, clearly happy with her success. Almost at the same time, Entrapta yells out.

"I got it, everything is of fline!" Around them, the streets are almost too quiet, as civilians and emergency service members start cautiously coming out of their hiding places.

Adora breathes a sigh of relief. Entrapta clamors about looking at the wreckage.

"Can we keep some bots and clones?" Entrapta's eyes shine at the prospect. Glimmer sighs.

"You can take a few bots for the lab, but we can't keep bringing clones back, they aren't pets." Entrapta wilts, looking to Arrow for

help.

"Not pets, lab partners!" Entrapta counters. Arrow smiles fondly .

"I think we have enough lab partners with the clone we reprogrammed last time. Let's focus on him alright?" Most of the Alliance feels weird about the clone Entrapta practically adopted but Arrow, Wildcat, and Scorpia all advocated for Entrapta's position. The compromise is no more clones.

"T rapt, let's get to headquarters and you can look at the new bots there." Wildcat approaches them, putting a hand on Entrapta's shoulder.

With the bots and clones disabled, the fight is over. Prime never makes an actual appearance, always choosing to speak through his clones. Entrapta is fascinated by the hive mind and is researching how it works and better ways to disrupt it.

"Okay!" Entrapta easily agreed. They all head for the transport and Adora eyes Wildcat. She purposefully bumps into her to get her attention. Wildcat gives her a friendly smile.

"That was a pretty cool move you and Scorpia pulled. Hadn't seen it before." Wildcat' s smile turns into a smirk.

"Y eah, we practiced a bunch-" Wildcat's voice suddenly wobbles, "uh before. And at the Alliance gym now." Adora wants to ask what Wildcat meant when she said before, but she can see Wildcat is uncomfortable. Adora teases instead.

"Y ou know, Scorpia is a big girl, but I have super strength. I bet I could have helped you get all the way to the top of that bot first try. No tech claws required." Adora flexes her bicep in an exaggerated manner.

"What, you offering to throw me around the gym, She-ra?" Her tone dips low and she emits a faux gasp.

"I'm a taken woman!" Wildcat places a hand on her chest as if she couldn't believe the impropriety of Adora' s proposal. Adora sputters and turns red as Wildcat laughs in her face. She hears Glimmer snort as she overhears their banter.

"Y ou know I don't mean it like that! It would be fun is all!" Adora can't help but pout. Wildcat's laugh rounds out from its squeaky pitch as she smiles warmly.

"Y eah, it would be fun." Wildcat concedes.

"I'm always down to train at the gym. Scorpia, Perfuma, and I usually go Monday nights if you want to join." Adora thinks about her schedule. Catra is usually busy on Mondays, so that works well.

"Y eah, Ill try to make it then!" She-ra and Wildcat exchange a shoulder bump again as they both climb into the transport.

They are eating Thai take-out and watching a movie, some B-list horror that is all jump scares. Catra' s apartment is small but cozy. They are currently snuggling in blankets and pillows that protect them from the well-loved leather couch.

Although Catra occasionally hits some of her bruises from the fight earlier in the day, Adora stays silent and nuzzles further into her embrace. Catra grips her arm tighter as another demon suddenly graces the screen. She didn't know contentment like this existed.

Catra turns in Adora's arms as the movie drags on. Adora looks down, her hands squeezing Catra's hips lightly , mindful of her strength. She never wants to hurt Catra. Catra reaches up and kisses her chastely. Adora sighs.

"Y ou know, I can't get over the fact that we can do that now ," Adora says dreamily. It had been a few months since Catra took her out on that first date and they decided to be girlfriends. Catra snorts.

I cant get over how many years we spent not kissing. Y ou know, given that you saw me and instantly fell for all of my charms.”Adora deeply regrets telling Catra how she almost spilled her coffee the first time she saw her in their first and only shared college class.

"Y ou cant make fun of me for liking you, Im your girlfriend. That’ s my whole job!"Adora wriggles Catra away so she can look at her with fauxdisapproval. Catra raises her eyebrow .

"Exactly . You are my girlfriend, so I can make fun of you for whatever I want. Now stay still, Im trying to get comfy ."Catra nestles herself along Adora’s collarbone. It makes Adora’s heart do funny things.

"How was your day Cat?"Catra looks up, her eyes, one blue the other a light hazel, sparkling with whatever story Catra is cooking up. Adora is always amazed how Catra’s eyes could both be so beautiful and so different at once.

"It went really great actually!I was running into a big problem on one of my projects and I found a solution that was not only innovative, but it cut my costs in terms of time and resources."

Catra did a lot of freelance coding. Given that Adora barely manages to get through her computer updates, Catra's work descriptions are best kept broad and abstract. Catra continues, waving a hand in the air.

"I think I really impressed the client and some other people working on the project with me. Not that I have to impress anyone but its nice to get noticed you know?"Catra suddenly hides her face in Adora's shirt. This was one of her favorite things about Catra: when she was vulnerable, she was so soft and shy.

"Y ou impress me all the time Catra. You are so smart and capable, there is nothing you cant do."Adora could feel the word love bubbling on the tip of her tongue. She chokes it back. Catra’s tan skin looks flushed.

"Enough about me, tell me about your day ."Adora' s palms start to sweat. She hasn't dropped by her job today . Her day job at any rate. The silence draws a little long, Catra moves her head so she can look at Adora's face.

"C'mon, tell me about all your animals horse girl."Catra teases, her smile wide and eyes honest. Adora's hand creeps behind her neck.

"Nothing crazy . We have a mare who might give birth any day now, but the owners are too nervous to handle it on their own. I'm kind of on call in case one of the stable hands notices she is in labor."There that's true.

As she pulls back, she unexpectedly feels a shooting pain down her arm radiating from her shoulder. She yelps in surprise. Catra's brow furrows as she reaches for Adora's long sleeve.

"What's up with your arm?"The real answer is that one of Prime's clones tried to rip her arm out of its socket before Arrow could hit him. She can't say that.

"Um, I got kicked by a horse today . I didn't want to worry you."The words sound nervous because they are.

"Is that what you are being all cagey about?Let me see."She reaches gingerly to touch Adora's shoulder . Adora doesn't pull back, but she grabs Catra's hand placing a kiss on it instead.

"No!It's ugly I don't want you to see me bruised like that."She isn't sure that the bruises would look like a horse kicked her and she doesn't want to answer more questions.

"Fine. What can I do to make you feel better?"Catra looks at Adora carefully, pressing a hand soothingly over her arm.

"Kisses might make me feel better?"Adora eyes her hopefully . She gets the reaction she wants. Catra guffaws and rolls her eyes at her.

"You are such a baby. Come here. Let me know if you need me to be gentler."Catra pulls her close and starts dropping feather-light kisses on her jaw, her face, her neck. It makes Adora giggle.

"You can be rougher than that."Adora goads as Catra's eyes immediately darken. An absolutely feral look overtakes her features, which usually means good things are in Adora's future. Adora can feel her gut clenching in anticipation. Catra raises one eyebrow challengingly.

"Oh yeah? Let's see how rough princess likes it."Adora shivers as Catra sets to work, kissing Adora with abandon. Adora lets herself melt into the kiss.

The rest of the night is wonderful and Adora goes to sleep her favorite way, with Catra lightly snoring in her arms. She tries to fall asleep, but she can't move past the queasy feeling in her stomach from lying to Catra. It is going to be a long night.

She is in the main building of the veterinary clinic, which usually isn't where she works. It's a nice reprieve from the smell of the stables.

"Razz, I think Double Under might need to get that hoof looked at sooner rather than later, he looks very uncomfortable."Razz waves her hand at Adora.

"I know. It is just as dangerous to overcook a pie as it is to undercook it, that's why we pay attention."With that puzzling statement, Razz confidently walks out to the stables.

"I have no idea what that's supposed to mean,"Starla whispers, holding a teething puppy.

"Me neither. I'm still pumped I get to help you do the checkups for the kittens and puppies."It is set to be a great workday. She takes a picture of Starla holding the puppy, ready to text it to Catra.

She frowns as she shakes the tugging at her gut when she thinks of Catra. It took her three full hours to fall asleep the night before, the guilt slowly gnawing on her from the inside out. She never felt great about lying to Catra, but since they got together, she could feel the weight of the lies on her shoulders. Starla notices Adora's frown.

"What has you looking so down? You have been on cloud nine since you and Catra started dating."Adora contemplates telling Starla about her problem. She looks around to confirm the room is empty, save the animals.

"I haven't told her that I'm... *friends* with She-ra. I lied to her yesterday about something, and I feel bad."Starla snorts at Adora's phrasing. Friends indeed.

"I mean it's normal to feel guilty about lying to your partner . It's a pretty big thing to hide from her."Starla shoots Adora a look filled with judgment as she puts the puppy back in his crate. Starla continues.

"Honestly , I'm surprised she hasn't gotten it out of you yet, you are a terrible liar. I barely had to ask you anything when you told me." Starla grins wide as she no doubt recalls what was one of the most embarrassing moments in Adora's life.

Adora's face burns as she remembers that Starla caught her naked in the barn with her sword. Adora stood too close to Wildcat when she became a literal human flame and half her suit was scorched.

The veterinarian clinic was closer than headquarters and she saw no harm in changing in the back. Adora panicked when Starla came by to check on a horse. The truth spilled out of Adora in hopes Starla wouldn't think she was some pervert. It was the last time she failed to go straight to headquarters after a fight.

"You caught me in a vulnerable position!What else was I supposed to say?"Adora sighs, shoulders slumped. She puts her hand in her lab coat.

I want her to know , I just worry ."Adora bites her lip as she turns, checking on some of the patients. She holds a small kitten and pets it as she continues.

"There is a dif ference between dating a vet tech and a superhero. I mean, what if it's too much? What if Im too much?"Adora lowers her gaze as she gives voice to her deepest insecurities.

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"Adora!"Starla exclaims, slapping Adora's arm. Adora's cheeks somehow blaze hotter.

"W e have only been dating for like three months!"Adora defends. Starla sees through her.

"That's like, eons in lesbian years! Besides you've been in love with her forever! What are you waiting for?"Adora falters, thinking of what to say. She looks down at the ground as she speaks to Starla.

"I just need to make sure she feels the same. I mean what if she doesn't? Or worse, what if I tell her who I am and she takes it back?" Panic claws at Adora's throat. Starla places a comforting hand on her shoulder.

"Adora stop worrying about being too much for anyone, especially Catra. If anything, worry about being enough for yourself. Be honest. Tell her who you are and how you feel."Adora thinks over Starla' s words.

"You are right. I'm going to tell her." It's not like Adora can live with the guilt now anyways.

"That you love her, or about your *friend*?" Starla raises an eyebrow, crossing her arms.

"Both." Adora holds another cat, hoping that it will help keep the anxiety at bay.

Adora gets a reservation at one of the best restaurants in Bright Moon, courtesy of Entrapta's hacking skills, to take Catra out on a date.

Adora stares at her closet in despair. First, she tries on her charcoal suit, but she remembers that she recently wore it when they went to the theater. She then tries on a red sleeveless dress, but she doesn't quite like the fit of it.

By the end of her search for appropriate clothes, she is laying on her bed in a pile of her own clothes looking up at her ceiling. She rummages through her closet again and repeats the process.

She finally settles on a white and gold dress she bought but never had a chance to wear. Maybe Catra will tease her for wearing She-Ra's colors later tonight. If everything goes well.

Adora picks Catra up from her apartment, jaw-dropping as she takes in her outfit. Catra is wearing burgundy tailored slacks and a vest. Her crisp white shirt is rolled up to her forearms, her typically riotous short curls styled in a way that makes them look extra bouncy. Catra smirks, clearly enjoying the way Adora's eyes rove over her.

"You look amazing." Adora offers, smiling at her girlfriend.

"I always look good in my suits." Catra's twinkle like she told Adora an inside joke. Adora is still busy staring.

"You certainly do." Adora intones. Catra looks at Adora's outfit and lets out a low whistle.

"I like your dress princess." Adora's cheeks redden. They hurry into the car, Catra teasing Adora the whole way.

They have a fantastic meal. Catra gushes over the choice of restaurant, making Adora's heart feel like it would burst.

"How did you even get a reservation? I think the waitlist on this place is like six months!" Adora smiles and tries to be suave.

"I know someone with an in." A *probably illegal in* she adds silently. Catra continues to peruse the dessert menu.

"I can't pick between the chocolate mousse and the crème brule. On the one hand, this place is fancy I should get a fancy dessert. On the other hand, you have chocolate. What do you think Dora? I should probably get both right?" Catra asks, still looking down at the menu. Adora's nerves start building up again.

"Catra, I have something important to tell you." Adora blurts out. Catra looks up from her menu, eyes concerned. She reaches her hand across the table and squeezes Adora's hand.

"Of course, Dora, you can tell me anything." Adora takes a deep breath as Catra rubs her hand. Her heart feels like it's trying to beat out of her chest.

"Are you alright? You look like you might pass out on me." Although Catra tries to lighten the mood, her eyes are still serious.

"I might," Adora admits, "It's just a big thing about who I am, and I think it'll be shocking but I want you to know me. All of me. I don't want to hide or lie anymore." Catra's brow twitches at that but she nods along, giving Adora space. Adora takes the plunge.

"Cat, I'm She-ra." Catra furrows her brow looking confused.

"What do you mean you are She-ra?" Catra whispers it across the table. Adora thought she might need some proof to show Catra, so she is prepared. She looks around and finds no one is paying attention to them.

"It means I am She-ra. Part of the Alliance." She holds Catra's gaze as she taps into the well that is her magic, thinking of the love she has for Catra. Catra gasps and Adora knows she saw her eyes flash an electric glowing blue.

"I'm still me though. Adora. It' s just another part of me. It doesnt have to change things between us." She waits for Catra to say something, on the edge of her seat. Catra doesnt say anything. Catra's eyes widen, her jaw falls slack. Her hand is shaking as she slips it out of Adora's grip. It feels like more than just Catra's hand is slipping through Adora's fingers.

"I- I- need a minute Adora. Ill be right back." Catra speed walks towards the bathroom and Adora feels her heart crumbling in her chest.

Its too much, she is too much, Catra doesnt want a freak like Adora who would constantly put her in danger. She is going to lose Catra over this thing she cant control. She supposes she could quit the Alliance but would that even be enough? Catra ran.

She tries to sit tight, she really does. She wants to go after Catra but she also wants to respect her space. Her palms are sweating, arms shaking. She sits on her hands, hoping that will stop the trembling. She feels like her heart might explode while waiting.

Adora suddenly realizes that there is an explosion, but it isnt one of her internal organs. The noise is jarring, all the tableware in the restaurant shakes as Adora ducks down under the table. She looks up, smoke coming out of the hallway Catra walked through moments ago. She runs towards it without a second thought.

Adora smacks into multiple patrons running away from the wreckage, slowing her progress. She finally makes it into the hallway where parts of the walls have crumbled. Her eyes desperately search Catra. She can barely see past the smoke, but she continues to move forward.

Some of the smoke and ash start to clear and Adora sees a tall tan woman standing in the dead center of the hallway. Her dark hair is pulled back in a ponytail and her eyes flash from a glowing blue to brown.

She is wearing her Grayskull uniform, flowing gray and white cinched at her waist. She casually holds her sword over her shoulder as if she wouldnt strike at Adora at the first provocation. Adora knows she would like nothing more. Her sister smiles sweetly at Adora, brown eyes too bright.

"Mara."Adora curses.

"I have something of yours, Adora dear . If you want to get her back, you know what you need to do." *No. No, no, no, she can't mean Catra.*

Adoras gaze moves past Mara, and she catches sight of Catras unruly locks hunched over the shoulder of a Grayskull cadet, her arms hanging limp.

Adora breaks into a sprint but Mara plants a swift kick to Adoras gut, knocking her backward and leaving her breathless. Adora immediately turns and grabs Mara’s leg, stopping her from following her cadets out the back of the restaurant.

Mara kicks down with her other leg, catching Adora’s head with her boot. Adora can feel her brain rattle in her head and headache bloom behind her eyes. Adora doesnt let go of Mara, pulling hard and sending Mara sprawling herself.

"You can never make anything easy, can you Adora?" Mara grits out, bring her sword down, narrowly missing Adora. Adora and Mara both get back up on their feet and start fighting in earnest.

Adora's eyes keep flickering behind Mara, watching for any sign of Catra. The more time that goes by the more she panics, her motions more desperate as she tries to just get past Mara. Mara takes advantage of Adora's distraction, bringing the blunt end of her sword to strike Adora's temple.

Adora's vision goes out as she hits the ground. She doesn't think she loses consciousness for long but by the time she gets up, she doesn't see any Grayskull uniforms. She runs through the hallway to the back exit, where the door is busted open. She falls on her knees in that dirty alleyway near the restaurant's dumpster.

This is exactly her worst nightmare. She failed Catra. She promised herself she would keep Catra safe, convinced herself that she could have both. She could have Catra and keep her safe. She is wrong on both counts. She dials Shimmer as she runs back to her car.

"She-ra, this is a little late for a social call." Shimmer greets her, humor in her voice. Adora whispers urgently, foregoing a greeting.

"The Grayskull Squadron took my girlfriend. I need help getting her back." Shimmer gasps. She hears her shuffling on the line.

"Of course. They won't get away with taking one of ours, I can promise you that. I'll assemble the Alliance and I'll have Entrapta triangulate her location using her phone before they disable it." Glimmer sounds incensed.

"We will get her, I promise." Adora hangs up, not bothering to reply.

Adora doesn't notice Shimmer's words claiming Catra, doesn't wonder how she knows Catra's phone number, doesn't think how, surely, her eyes are glowing bright blue and must be freaking out whatever waitstaff took the back exit after the explosion.

There is only one thought in Adora's mind. She is going to get her girlfriend back, no matter the cost.

End Notes

So I would say this is my first cliffhanger?

I apologize for the hurt but the comfort is on its way!

The next installment will wrap up the main arc of this superhero universe and it is much longer than the rest of the one-shots posted. The rough draft currently sits at around 7k and I know for a fact BlueCoin00 is going to demolish it and make me add a lot more to it lol.

As I come to the end of this arc, I would love to know what you all would like to read, both inside of this universe and outside of it!

As always, comments and kudos are super appreciated. All comments have generated approximately *checks notes*18.5k words that I was not intending to write for this universe.

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!